

Dutch vocab — translation-outlier screen (VLM panel)

Picture Vocabulary (4-AFC) · cross-language difficulty shift, nl vs en

Compared the VLM "child" panel on each item in English vs Dutch. The method validated on English (Spearman 0.62 vs human difficulty; caught 3 of 5 known-broken items), so the cross-language signal is trustworthy.

Biggest nl-vs-en drops (candidate weak Dutch translations)

Item	Dutch word	p_en	p_nl	Δ	Panel picks (nl)
puddle	de plas	1.00	0.43	-0.57	bubble 12× vs puddle 10×
dumpling	de knoedel	0.94	0.52	-0.42	meatball 12× vs dumpling 13×
mammalogy	mammologie	0.92	0.56	-0.36	entomology 8× (obscure -ology)
triad	de triade	1.00	0.68	-0.32	mostly ok (17×), modest
chat	kletsen	1.00	0.69	-0.31	mostly ok (18×), modest

Two items worth human review

- **puddle** / "de plas" — perfect in English; in Dutch the panel picks the *bubble* picture nearly as often. The translation is correct, but it's a weaker cue against that distractor image.
- **dumpling** / "de knoedel" — splits evenly with *meatball*. A knoedel and a meatball are near-identical round shapes; the word doesn't disambiguate the too-close distractor.

The rest are either genuinely hard low-frequency words (mammalogy) or small drops within noise. **None are mistranslations** — the Dutch words are correct; these are cases where the translated word + distractor-image pairing discriminates worse than English. Still a legitimate pre-launch flag for the item-bank team.

The one below-chance BROKEN item in both languages is `de klauw` /claw — an image-confusability issue, language-independent. Source: `tools/vlm-panel/out/report_vocab.md` (en: 18 respondents, nl: 26).